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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 2 : Session – 1 | Human Being as Co-existence of Self and Body

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. The human being is the CO-EXISTENCE of the Self ('I') and the Body. NEED: the Self's need is happiness (respect, trust, understanding) — continuous in time; the Body's need is physical facility (food, shelter) — temporary. ACTIVITY: the Self's activities are knowing, assuming, recognising, fulfilling, desiring, thinking — continuous; the Body's activities are eating, walking, breathing — temporary. RESPONSE: the Self's response includes knowing and assuming — hence not always definite; the Body's response is DEFINITE (physico-chemical — it burns, digests, grows per natural laws). The two are distinct yet inseparable — the Self is the seer/doer/enjoyer; the Body is the instrument.
2. Q2. The response of the Self consists of KNOWING (understanding reality as it is), ASSUMING (the image/belief I hold), RECOGNISING (identifying the relationship with the other), and FULFILLING (acting out that recognition). The Body's response is definite because it is physico-chemical and law-governed — fire always burns, poison always harms. The Self's response is NOT always definite because it depends on my ASSUMPTION: if I assume without knowing, my recognition and behaviour vary with beliefs and conditioning; only when assuming is based on knowing does the response become definite.
3. Q3. ASSUMING WITH KNOWING: my assumptions are verified against reality through self-exploration — e.g., knowing that every human being is a co-existence of Self and Body, I assume the other is like me and naturally feel respect -> definite, harmonious conduct = SWATANTRATA (self-organisation). ASSUMING WITHOUT KNOWING: assumptions taken from preconditioning or hearsay — e.g., 'respect is due only to the rich/strong' -> conduct changes with external labels, unpredictable and often exploitative = PARTANTRATA (dependence/enslavement). The first makes conduct stable and universally good; the second makes it a slave of opinion.
4. Q4. The loop 'Self = Body, Respect = Physical Facility, Continuous = Unlimited' works like this: assuming I AM the body, my needs become only material; assuming respect comes from possessions, I chase status goods; assuming continuity requires unlimited accumulation, I can never feel 'enough' — result: endless accumulation, deprivation feeling, exploitation. MY OBSERVATION: on honest examination I find traces of this loop — e.g., the urge to buy the latest phone to feel 'updated/respected'. Recognising that the need behind it is of the Self (to feel good, be respected) breaks the loop and redirects effort to understanding and relationship.